

DS_A1_Q5

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1 Q5

To show that test MSE of model $Y = f(x) + \epsilon$,

$$E[(Y_0 - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] = \text{var}(\hat{f}(x_0)) + b_f(\hat{f}(x_0))^2 + \text{var}(\epsilon)$$

We could write the expression of test MSE first,

$$\begin{aligned} E[(Y_0 - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] &= E[(f(x_0) + \epsilon - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] \\ &= E[((f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0)) + \epsilon)^2] \\ &= E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] + 2 E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0)) \cdot E[\epsilon] + E[\epsilon^2]] \\ &= E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] + 2 E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0)) E[\epsilon] + E[\epsilon^2]] \end{aligned}$$

Since ϵ is a random error term that is independent of x and has mean zero, so

$$E[\epsilon] = 0, \quad \text{var}(\epsilon) = E[\epsilon^2]$$

Substitute the formulas into the derived test MSE expression,

$$\begin{aligned} E[(Y_0 - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] &= E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] + 2 E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0)) \cdot 0 + \text{var}(\epsilon)] \\ &= E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] + \text{var}(\epsilon) \end{aligned}$$

To further prove the result, we transform $f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0)$ as follows.

$$f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0) = (f(x_0) - E[\hat{f}(x_0)]) + (E[\hat{f}(x_0)] - \hat{f}(x_0))$$

Substitute to $E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0))^2]$, we can obtain that,

$$E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] = E[(E[\hat{f}(x_0)] - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] + E[(f(x_0) - E[\hat{f}(x_0)])^2] + 2 E[(E[\hat{f}(x_0)] - \hat{f}(x_0))(f(x_0) - E[\hat{f}(x_0)])]$$

Once more, ϵ is a random error term that is independent of x and has mean zero, so

$$\begin{aligned} E[\hat{f}(x_0)] &= E[f(x_0) + \epsilon] \\ &= E[f(x_0)] + E[\epsilon] \\ &= f(x_0) \end{aligned}$$

So we can infer that $2 E[(E[\hat{f}(x_0)] - \hat{f}(x_0))(f(x_0) - E[\hat{f}(x_0)])] = 0$.

According to the property of variance and the definition of bias,

$$\text{var}(\hat{f}(x_0)) = E[(E[\hat{f}(x_0)] - \hat{f}(x_0))^2], b_f(\hat{f}(x_0))^2 = (f(x_0) - E[\hat{f}(x_0)])^2 = E[(f(x_0) - E[\hat{f}(x_0)])^2]$$

So the equation could be written by

$$\begin{aligned} E[(Y_0 - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] &= E[(f(x_0) - \hat{f}(x_0))^2] + \text{var}(\epsilon) \\ &= \text{var}(\hat{f}(x_0)) + b_f(\hat{f}(x_0))^2 + \text{var}(\epsilon) \end{aligned}$$